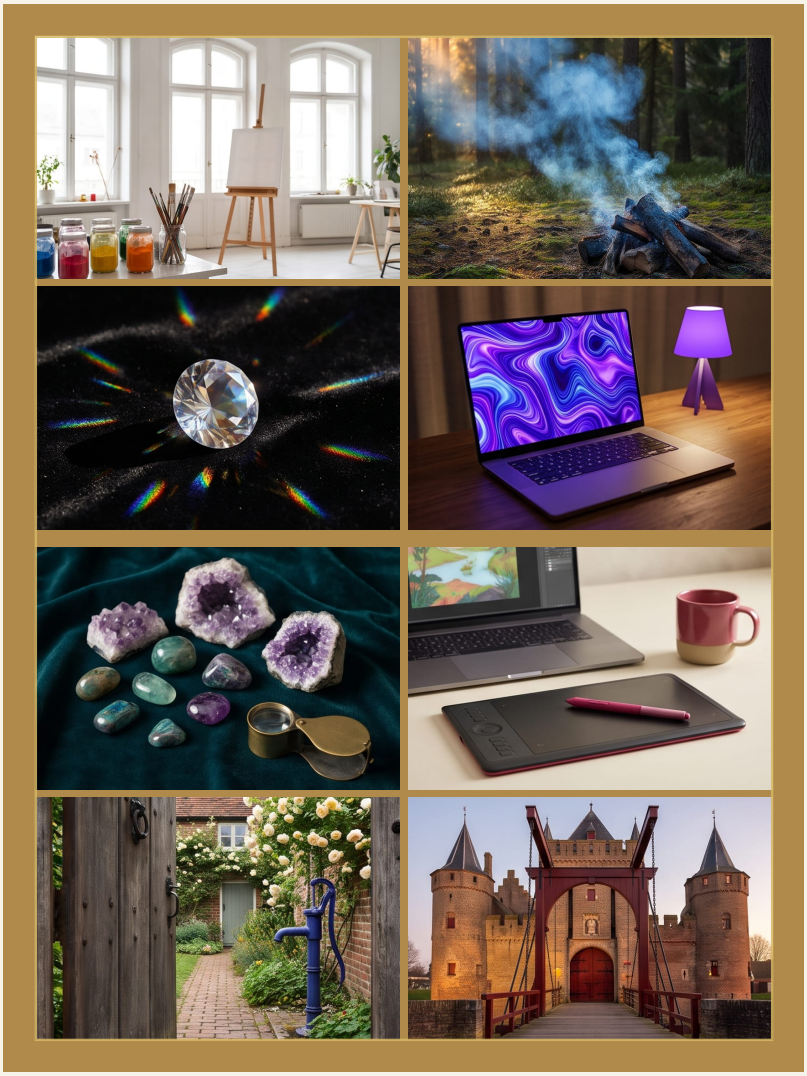
WINDOWINTO



Maastricht · Half a day · Up to €50

YOUR WINDOW IDEA BOOK · 10 NOVEMBER 2026

A window for you

A handful of possibilities, shaped around what you told us.



YOUR PROFILE

Someone in Maastricht with a free half-day and up to €50, drawn to colour, history, craft and the quiet satisfaction of figuring things out.

PREFERENCES

color · history · technique · collecting · craft

Four doors, each one a bit further

Your possibilities, mapped out

FAMILIAR
Close to what you already do, just worked out a little better.

Light, Colour, Screen · p. 3
Courtyards Behind the Façades · p. 5
Reading Stone by Stone · p. 7
Fortress Above the Valley · p. 9

DISCOVERY
Something that fits what you enjoy, that you just haven't tried yet.

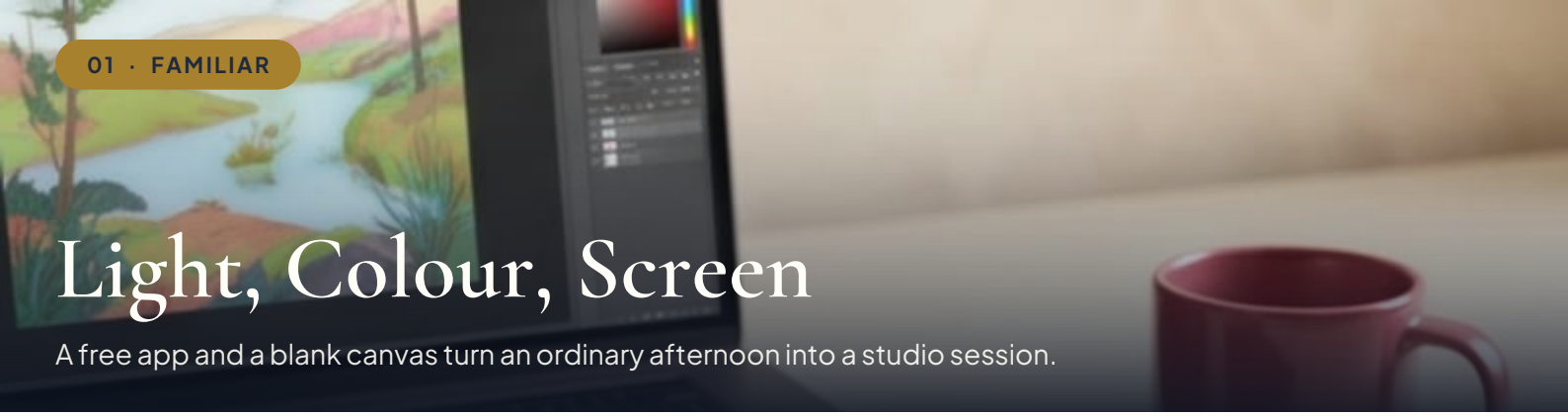
One Dress, A Long Look · p. 11

UNEXPECTED
Surprises you at first, until you read why it actually fits.

Tiles, Patterns, First Moves · p. 13

✦ IF YOU ONLY DO ONE THING

Courtyards Behind the Façades. This fits your situation best, and you can start today.



01 · FAMILIAR

Light, Colour, Screen

A free app and a blank canvas turn an ordinary afternoon into a studio session.

WHY THIS FITS YOU

You chose this on the cards, and the studio full of light you were drawn to starts right at your own desk. 2-3 hours for free: it fits your time (half a day) and your budget (up to €50). You chose this yourself. This door follows from the image 'a studio full of light', in which we read colour and craftsmanship.

TIME	LEVEL	TYPE
2–3 hours	Easy	Creative

YOUR EXPERIENCE

Creativity	●●●●●
Calm	●●●●●
Discovery	●●●○○
Social stimulus	●●○○○
Comfort zone	●●○○○

ONE POSSIBLE SHAPE

START
You open the app or arrive at the studio and set up your space.

DURING
You experiment with colour, layering light and shadow stroke by stroke.

WRAP-UP
You step back and look at the finished piece as a whole.

AFTERWARDS
You save or photograph the work, already thinking of the next one.

PRACTICAL

01 Download Procreate Pocket or the free app Krita on your tablet, phone or laptop.

02 Open a new canvas and search "digital painting for beginners tutorial" on YouTube to follow along.

03 Optional: look up Vrije Academie Maastricht's drawing and painting courses at vrijeacademie-maastricht.nl for structured monthly sessions.

YOUR INVESTMENT

Free

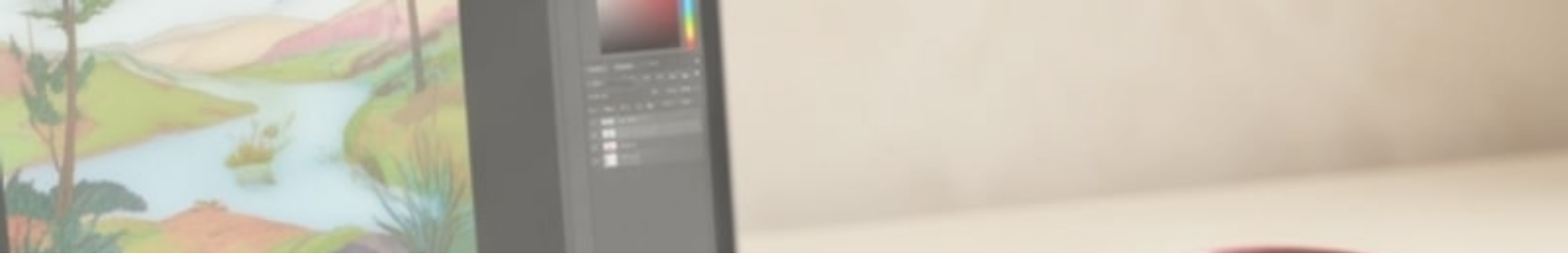
Estimated cost

Within your original budget.

START HERE

www.vrijeacademie-maastricht.nl

Open the App Store or Google Play now and install Krita or Procreate Pocket.



MORE ABOUT THIS DOOR · FAMILIAR

Light, Colour, Screen

HOW IT FEELS

Light spills across the screen as colour builds in layers under your hand. The quiet hum of focus settles in, broken only by the soft tap of stylus on glass.

THREE SIZES

TASTE
About 1 hour

First strokes

Try a free app and sketch something small just to feel it out.

Free · about 1 hour

DO
Half a day

A proper session

Join a beginner drawing and painting session to build real technique.

from about €25 · about half a day

GO FURTHER
A weekend or a course

Monthly course

Follow a monthly course to develop a personal style over time.

from about €90/month · weeks, ongoing

REAL PLACES

From our research. Check opening times and prices yourself.

Vrije Academie Maastricht – Tekenen en schilderen, Maastricht

Drawing and painting courses for beginners and advanced learners with various materials; regular monthly sessions

On the map Website

ALSO IN THIS DIRECTION

Graffiti or mural painting · Quilting · Stained glass or mosaic

NEXT

Book a second session at the same course to keep building on what you learned.



02 · FAMILIAR

Courtyards Behind the Façades

Maastricht hides its best rooms behind plain doors, and a short walk finds them.

WHY THIS FITS YOU

You chose discovering hidden courtyards yourself, and this walk puts you right inside them. Count on €15-20; that stays within your budget (up to €50) and fits in half a day. You chose this yourself. In the chosen images we read stillness.

TIME	LEVEL	TYPE
1.5 hours	Easy	Culture

YOUR EXPERIENCE

Creativity	●●●○○
Calm	●●●●●
Discovery	●●●○○
Social stimulus	●●○○○
Comfort zone	●●○○○

ONE POSSIBLE SHAPE

START
You meet the group or set off alone from a central square.

DURING
You move through narrow passages into one hidden courtyard after another.

WRAP-UP
You pause in the last courtyard, taking in its quiet detail.

PRACTICAL

01 Book the 1.5-hour Rondleiding Maastricht tour at rondleidingmaastricht.nl, which includes courtyards and heritage buildings.

02 Meet the small group at the agreed starting point in the historic centre and follow the guide's route.

03 You'll need: Booking confirmation, Comfortable shoes

YOUR INVESTMENT

€15-20

Estimated cost

Within your original budget.

START HERE

rondleidingmaastricht.nl

Go to the address above now and check the next available tour date.



MORE ABOUT THIS DOOR · FAMILIAR

Courtyards Behind the Façades

HOW IT FEELS

Cobbled alleys open suddenly into quiet courtyards, sunlight catching old brick and ivy. Voices and footsteps fade behind you as the city reveals a hidden, private calm.

THREE SIZES

TASTE
About 1 hour

Solo wander

Walk the old town centre yourself and peek through open gates.

Free · about 1 hour

DO
Half a day

Guided courtyard walk

Join a historical walking tour through courtyards and heritage buildings.

from about €15 · about half a day

GO FURTHER
A weekend or a course

Deeper exploration

Repeat the walk in a different season to see the courtyards change.

from about €15 · a few hours

REAL PLACES

From our research. Check opening times and prices yourself.

Rondleiding Maastricht – Monumentaal Maastricht, Maastricht

1.5–hour historical walking tour through historic centre, including courtyards and heritage buildings; small groups welcome

On the map Website

Stadswandeling Maastricht, Maastricht

1.5–hour walk through highlights of Maastricht's history with local guide and rest on terrace

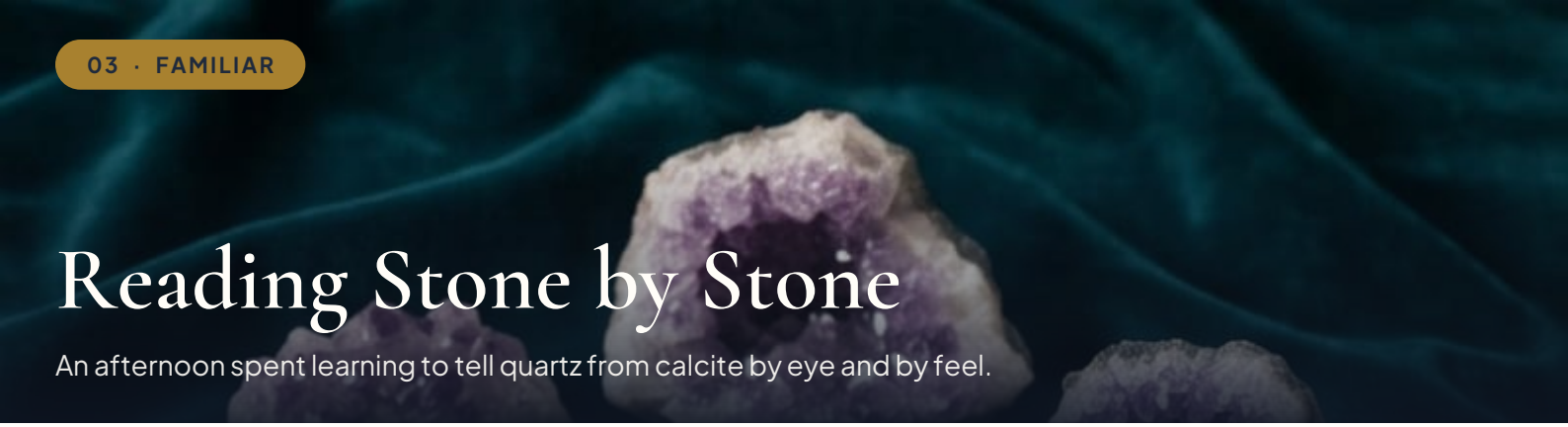
On the map Website

ALSO IN THIS DIRECTION

Bunker and fort tour · Indexing archive records as a volunteer · Crossbow shooting (guild)

NEXT

Return on a different day to find courtyards the first route didn't cover.



03 · FAMILIAR

Reading Stone by Stone

An afternoon spent learning to tell quartz from calcite by eye and by feel.

WHY THIS FITS YOU

You chose minerals and gemstones yourself, and the glittering facets you were drawn to are waiting on the shelves. With €10-30 and 2 hours you are well within what you gave (half a day, up to €50). You chose this yourself. This door follows from the image 'glittering facets', in which we read colour and collecting.

TIME	LEVEL	PLACE	TYPE
2 hours	Easy	Maastricht	Markets & shopping

YOUR EXPERIENCE

Creativity	●●○○○
Calm	●●●○○
Discovery	●●●○○
Social stimulus	●●●●○
Comfort zone	●●○○○

ONE POSSIBLE SHAPE

START
You step into the shop or centre and scan the glittering cabinets.

DURING
You handle a few stones, comparing weight, colour and shine.

WRAP-UP
You pick one piece that genuinely caught your eye.

AFTERWARDS
You leave with a stone and a little new vocabulary for it.

PRACTICAL

01 Visit Stapel van Stenen at stapelvanstenen.nl, an independent knowledge centre with a library and courses on gemstones.

02 Ask staff which minerals are good starter pieces to handle and compare, then browse NOVA LUA nearby for specimens to take home.

YOUR INVESTMENT

€10-30

Estimated cost

Within your original budget.

WHERE?

Stapel van Stenen
Maastricht

view on map →

START HERE

stapelvanstenen.nl

Check the address above now for today's opening hours and any beginner course.



MORE ABOUT THIS DOOR · FAMILIAR

Reading Stone by Stone

HOW IT FEELS

Cabinets glow under soft light, facets catching every angle like tiny fires. The hush of the shop holds the mineral smell of stone and quiet concentration.

THREE SIZES

TASTE
About 1 hour

Shop visit

Browse a mineral shop and learn to spot a few key stones.

Free to browse · about 1 hour

DO
Half a day

Learning session

Visit a knowledge centre for a guided look at gemstones and minerals.

from about €20 · about half a day

GO FURTHER
A weekend or a course

Short course

Take a course on mineral identification to go beyond browsing.

from about €45 · a weekend

REAL PLACES

From our research. Check opening times and prices yourself.

NOVA LUA, Maastricht

Gemstone and mineral shop in Maastricht Centre offering unique edelstenen, mineralen and handmade jewelry

On the map Website

Dirkx Mineralen, Maastricht

Gemstone and mineral shop offering curated collections of edelstenen, mineralen and spiritual products; experience-focused

On the map Website

Stapel van Stenen, Maastricht

Independent knowledge centre for gemstones and minerals offering library, community, courses and learning resources

On the map Website

ALSO IN THIS DIRECTION

Fossil and mineral hunting · **Dioramas and scenery** · **Fountain pens and typewriters**

NEXT

Sign up for a short identification course to turn curiosity into real knowledge.



04 · FAMILIAR

Fortress Above the Valley

A climb to a historic fort rewards you with the whole city and valley laid out below.

WHY THIS FITS YOU

You chose castles, churches and heritage sites, and the studio full of light shows up here in the open valley views. This costs about €5-10, and you chose half a day and up to €50: it works. You chose this yourself. This door follows from the image 'a studio full of light', in which we read colour.

TIME	LEVEL	PLACE	TYPE
Half a day	Moderate	Maastricht	Culture

YOUR EXPERIENCE

Creativity	●●●○○
Calm	●●●●○
Discovery	●●●○○
Social stimulus	●●○○○
Comfort zone	●●○○○

ONE POSSIBLE SHAPE

START
You arrive at the fort or church and get your bearings.

DURING
You explore the halls, towers or crypt at your own pace.

WRAP-UP
You find one detail, carving or view that holds your attention.

AFTERWARDS
You step back outside, the building's scale still settling in.

PRACTICAL

01 Search "Fort Sint-Pieter Maastricht" on Google Maps and walk there or take the bus toward Sint-Pietersberg.

02 Explore the fortress at your own pace, reading the information panels about its history as you go.

03 You'll need: Comfortable walking shoes

YOUR INVESTMENT

€5-10

Estimated cost

Within your original budget.

WHERE?

Fort Sint-Pieter
Maastricht

view on map →

START HERE

Open Google Maps now and search "Fort Sint-Pieter Maastricht" to see the route from where you are.



MORE ABOUT THIS DOOR · FAMILIAR

Fortress Above the Valley

HOW IT FEELS

Stone walls rise around you, catching light the way an old studio might, dust and incense mingling in the air. Echoes travel far under vaulted ceilings, centuries pressing close.

THREE SIZES

TASTE
About 1 hour

Single visit

Explore one basilica or church with a self-guided look around.

Free to low cost · about 1 hour

DO
Half a day

Heritage half-day

Visit the fort and a church or basilica with an audio guide.

from about €15 · about half a day

GO FURTHER
A weekend or a course

Full exploration

Plan a weekend around several heritage sites across the city.

from about €40 · a weekend

REAL PLACES

From our research. Check opening times and prices yourself.

Fort Sint-Pieter, Maastricht

Historic fortress with magnificent views over Maastricht and the valleys; accessible for self-exploration or guided tours

On the map

Sint-Servaasbasiliek, Maastricht

Historic basilica at the Vrijthof, one of Maastricht's most prominent heritage sites

On the map

Sint-Janskerk, Maastricht

Historic church at the Vrijthof in Maastricht's city centre

On the map

ALSO IN THIS DIRECTION

Museum visit · An art history course · Heritage crafts

NEXT

Visit a second site soon, choosing one with a very different style or era.



05 · DISCOVERY

One Dress, A Long Look

Instead of rushing a whole museum, you spend real time with a single garment.

WHY THIS FITS YOU

You chose heritage sites for their history, and this shares that same thread while adding the glittering facets of fabric and embroidery. You stay within up to €50 at free, and half a day is enough. This door follows from the image 'glittering facets', in which we read colour and style.

TIME	LEVEL	TYPE
45–60 minutes	Easy	Outdoors

YOUR EXPERIENCE

Creativity	●●○○○
Calm	●●●●●
Discovery	●●●○○
Social stimulus	●●○○○
Comfort zone	●●○○○

ONE POSSIBLE SHAPE

START
You open the collection online or step into the gallery.

DURING
You scroll or walk until one garment stops you completely.

WRAP-UP
You study its fabric, cut and colour in close detail.

WHAT YOU TAKE AWAY

- A favourite garment and the story behind it.
- A sharper eye for fabric, cut and era.

MAKE IT YOURS

- [ ] Choose one dress and research who might have worn it.
- [ ] Compare fabric textures across two different decades.

PRACTICAL

01 Open modemuze.nl and browse the Dutch museum costume collections by period or colour.

02 Pick one dress or garment that catches your eye and read its full history and material notes.

03 You'll need: Internet connection

YOUR INVESTMENT

Free

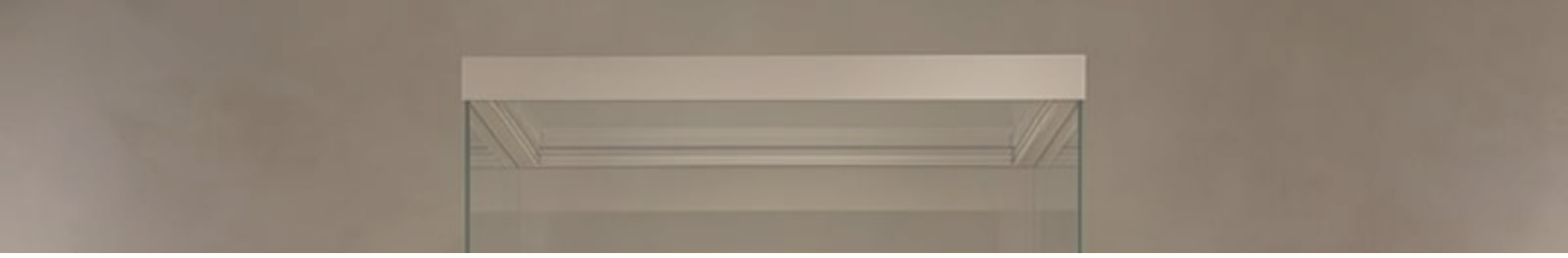
Estimated cost

Within your original budget.

START HERE

modemuze.nl

Go to the address above now and filter the collection by a colour that interests you.



MORE ABOUT THIS DOOR · DISCOVERY

One Dress, A Long Look

HOW IT FEELS

Fabric glints under museum light, sequins and embroidery catching like tiny facets as you lean close. The hush of the gallery holds decades of stitched detail still.

THREE SIZES

TASTE
About 1 hour

Online browse

Explore digitised costume collections from Dutch museums online.

Free · about 1 hour

DO
Half a day

Museum visit

Visit in person and choose one dress to study closely.

from about €15 · about half a day

GO FURTHER
A weekend or a course

Deeper dive

Research the full history behind your favourite garment or era.

Free to low cost · a few evenings

REAL PLACES

From our research. Check opening times and prices yourself.

ModeMuze, Online

Online platform with fashion and costume collections from Dutch museums

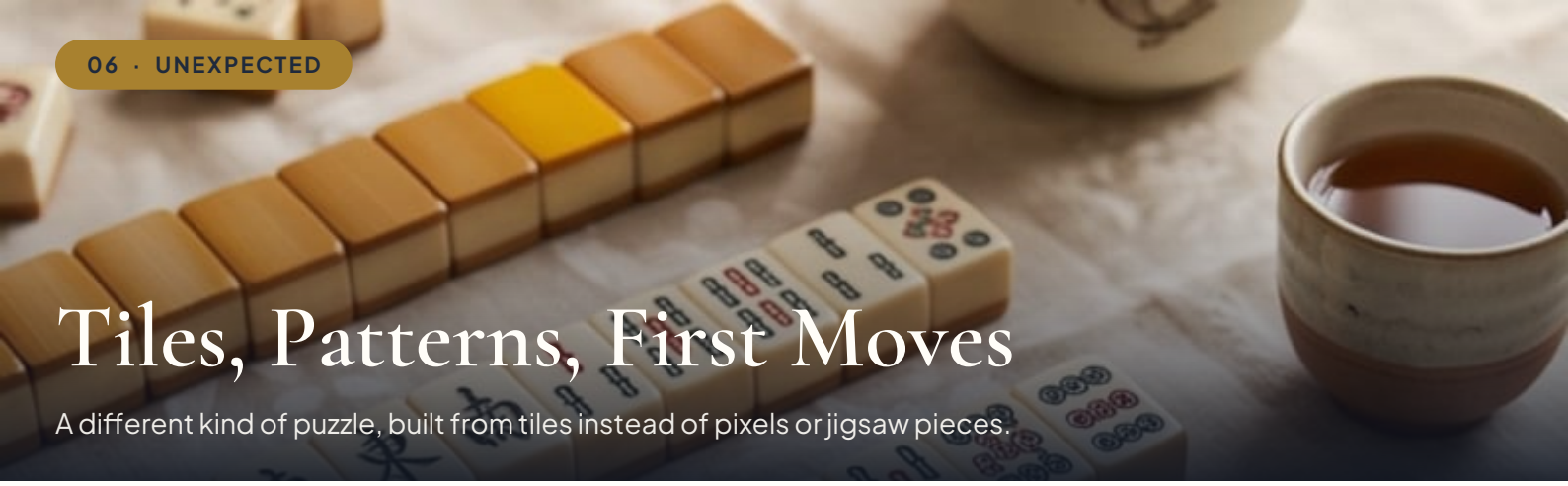
On the map Website

ALSO IN THIS DIRECTION

Colour analysis and style advice · **Learning nail styling and nail art** · **Printing fabric with wooden blocks**

NEXT

Pick another era online and compare how fabric and colour changed over time.



06 · UNEXPECTED

Tiles, Patterns, First Moves

A different kind of puzzle, built from tiles instead of pixels or jigsaw pieces.

WHY THIS FITS YOU

This sits far from your usual picks, but it shares the same puzzling pull as the coding and jigsaw interests behind it. It fits your time (half a day) and costs about free, well within up to €50.

TIME	LEVEL	TYPE
1–2 hours	Moderate	Social

YOUR EXPERIENCE

Creativity	●●○○○
Calm	●●○○○
Discovery	●●●●○
Social stimulus	●●●●●
Comfort zone	●●●○○

ONE POSSIBLE SHAPE

START
You sit down at the table as tiles are shuffled and dealt.

DURING
You learn the patterns, building a hand tile by tile.

WRAP-UP
You call your first winning combination, however small.

AFTERWARDS
You pack away the tiles, already planning the next game.

PRACTICAL

01 Go to mahjongacademy.org and start the free beginner course with step-by-step tutorials.

02 Once comfortable with the basics, search the Nederlandse Mahjong Bond site at mahjongbond.org for a club near Maastricht to play in person.

03 You'll need: Laptop or tablet

YOUR INVESTMENT

Free

Estimated cost

Within your original budget.

START HERE

mahjongacademy.org

Open the address above now and start lesson one of the beginner course.



MORE ABOUT THIS DOOR · UNEXPECTED

Tiles, Patterns, First Moves

HOW IT FEELS

Tiles click softly across the table, patterns shifting as the game narrows toward its finish. Laughter and concentration mix in the small, focused circle around you.

THREE SIZES

TASTE
About 1 hour

First tiles

Try a free online tutorial to learn the basic Mahjong rules.

Free · about 1 hour

DO
Half a day

Beginner afternoon

Join a beginner afternoon at a community centre or specialist shop.

from about €10 · about half a day

GO FURTHER
A weekend or a course

Join a club

Join a local club affiliated with the national association to play regularly.

from about €15/month · ongoing, weekly

REAL PLACES

From our research. Check opening times and prices yourself.

Mahjong Academy, Online

Free online course with step-by-step tutorials for beginners, AI coaching, multiple Mahjong styles

On the map Website

Nederlandse Mahjong Bond, Nederland

National association with 30 affiliated clubs throughout the Netherlands for learning and playing Mahjong

On the map Website

ALSO IN THIS DIRECTION

Go · Sudoku · Practising negotiation

NEXT

Find a regular club session so the rules turn into real strategy.



THE WILDCARD

Smoke on the Valley Wind

We probably shouldn't suggest a four-hour walk when you came for stones, but here we are.

WHY THIS FITS YOU

It drifts far from the gemstones you picked, but it carries the smoke of a wood fire you were drawn to. This door follows from the image 'smoke of a wood fire', in which we read outdoors and nature.

TIME	LEVEL	TYPE
4–4.5 hours	Demanding	Outdoors

YOUR EXPERIENCE

Creativity	●●○○○
Calm	●●●●○
Discovery	●●●●○
Social stimulus	●●○○○
Comfort zone	●●●●●

ONE POSSIBLE SHAPE

START
You set off from the fort or the city centre on foot.

DURING
You follow the marked route past quarry edges or old streets.

WRAP-UP
You stop somewhere quiet to catch your breath and look around.

AFTERWARDS
You finish the walk, legs tired, head noticeably clearer.

PRACTICAL

01 Search "NS-Walk Valkenburg aan de Geul" on AllTrails to find the full route from Maastricht to Schin op Geul.

02 Follow the Geul Valley trail markers for 10+ miles, pausing at any village along the way to warm up with coffee or soup.

03 You'll need: Walking shoes, Water bottle, Weatherproof jacket

YOUR INVESTMENT

Free

Estimated cost

Within your original budget.

START HERE

www.alltrails.com/en-gb/trail/netherlands/limburg/stadswandeling-maastricht

Open the AllTrails app now and save the NS-Walk Valkenburg aan de Geul route to your list.



MORE ABOUT THIS DOOR · THE WILDCARD

Smoke on the Valley Wind

HOW IT FEELS

Gravel crunches underfoot as the path opens past quarry edges and old vineyards. Woodsmoke drifts faintly on the breeze, mixing with damp earth and distant birdsong.

THREE SIZES

TASTE
About 1 hour

Short trail

Walk the easy trail past the quarry edges to the ruins.

Free · about 1.5 hours

DO
Half a day

City walk

Follow the historic centre walking route at an easy pace.

Free · about half a day

GO FURTHER
A weekend or a course

Long valley walk

Take the longer route through the Geul Valley to Schin op Geul.

Free · 4 to 4.5 hours

REAL PLACES

From our research. Check opening times and prices yourself.

Maastricht City Walk, Maastricht

Easy city walk through historic center, 5.8 km, approximately 1.5–2 hours

On the map Website

NS-Walk: Valkenburg aan de Geul, Maastricht

Moderate long walk from Maastricht to Schin op Geul through the Geul Valley, 10.1–10.7 mi, 4–4.5 hours

On the map Website

Fort Sint-Pieter Green Trail, Maastricht

Easy trail from Fort Sint-Pieter along ENCI quarry edges to Lichtenberg ruins and vineyards, 3.2 mi, 1–1.5 hours

On the map Website

ALSO IN THIS DIRECTION

Guided nature walk · **Beginner walking group** · **Plogging: jogging and clearing litter**

NEXT

Pick a longer route next time and let the valley walk fill a whole day.